

Soon, the wings unfold and dry out.

Butterfly

In another 8–14 days, the chrysalis splits and a butterfly emerges. After about an hour, it is ready to fly. Instead of chomping leaves like it did as a caterpillar, the butterfly now sips flower nectar through a long tube called a proboscis.

Some monarch butterflies migrate over 3,000 miles (5,000 km) from Canada to Mexico.

A monarch butterfly can breed between three to eight days after emerging from the chrysalis.

Laying eggs

Females begin to lay eggs right after mating. The eggs, which are the size of pinheads, are laid singly and glued to milkweed leaves. A female monarch may lay 300–500 eggs over her lifetime.

Mass migration In fall, millions of monarch butterflies travel south from Canada and the United States to spend winter in Mexico. There, they huddle together in trees to stay warm. In spring, they head north again.



Moth silk cocoon Like butterflies, moths also go through complete metamorphosis, but many don't form a hard chrysalis. Instead, they spin a silk covering around the pupa called a cocoon. The silk can be used to make clothing.

